Case Management Software: Development Notes

November 6, 2026 · David · updated November 12, 2026

A running log of requirements for the case management software, kept separate from the No Excuses memo.

Updated requirements, Nov 12, 2026

These notes update the case module and contacts. Where they overlap with the log below, they replace the earlier entries: running notes now fall under the Synopsis, and the contact types here replace the Nov 6 list.

- **Case list.** Opening the case module shows only a list of cases. Clicking a case opens the full case matter.
- **Order.** The list runs from the most recently opened case down to the least recently opened.
- **Client and style.** Each row shows the client's name and the case style, and the list can be searched by both.
- **File number.** The file number is visible on every row without opening the case.
- **Appeals.** The Appeals tab can be removed if there is not enough room. It rarely matters when working a case in litigation.
- **Synopsis.** The Notes section is renamed Synopsis and works as a quick snapshot of the case.
- **Synopsis contents.** Date of loss, statute of limitations date, a brief summary of what the case is about (like the current notes), total medicals or amount of damages, insurance company information, and the client's date of birth and social security number.
- **Summary field.** The brief summary keeps the multi-line behavior: pressing Enter starts a new line.
- **Contacts.** Contacts get a date of birth and a social security number. Both matter for conflict checks and for giving information to medical providers.
- **Contact types.** Client, Opposing Party / Defendant, Attorney, Witness, Medical Provider, Litigation Support (for example a service or records retrieval company), and Other.

Notes log

Date	Area	Note
Nov 6, 2026	Case record	Add the client's name as its own field. The case style does not include it.
Nov 6, 2026	Case record	Keep the cause number, and add a separate internal file number.
Nov 6, 2026	Case record	Add an SOL deadline field.

Date	Area	Note
Nov 6, 2026	Status	Status is a dropdown: Intake, Property Damage, Treating, Demand Sent, Negotiating, Review for Suit, Suit Filed, Discovery, Mediation, Trial.
Nov 6, 2026	Notes	Pressing Enter in Notes starts a new line instead of keeping one long string of text.
Nov 6, 2026	Ticklers	Under Notes, show 2 or 3 ticklers for upcoming deadlines or upcoming internal tasks.
Nov 6, 2026	Dictation	Every line where you can type also supports dictation.
Nov 6, 2026	Contacts	On a new contact, add a date of birth field.
Nov 6, 2026	Contacts	On a new contact, add a social security number field.
Nov 6, 2026	Notes	Notes need to be more than free text.
Nov 6, 2026	Contacts	Contact type options: Client, Opposing Party, Attorney, Witness, Medical Provider, Litigation Support (for example a service or records retrieval company), and Other.
Nov 12, 2026	Case module	Opening the module shows a list of cases only, from most recently opened down. Each row shows the client's name, the case style, and the file number, and the list is searchable.
Nov 12, 2026	Case module	The Appeals tab can be removed if there is not enough room.
Nov 12, 2026	Synopsis	Rename Notes to Synopsis, a quick snapshot with date of loss, SOL date, a brief summary, total medicals or damages, insurance company information, and the client's date of birth and social security number.
Nov 12, 2026	Contacts	Date of birth and social security number are needed on contacts for conflict checks and for giving information to medical providers.
Nov 12, 2026	Contacts	Contact types: Client, Opposing Party / Defendant, Attorney, Witness, Medical Provider, Litigation Support, and Other.

Open questions

- ☐ Confirm that "separate case number client" means a client name field plus an internal file number, kept apart from the case style and the cause number.
- ☐ Whether the status list needs a closing status after Trial, such as Closed or Settled.
- ☐ How existing cases with an older status should map to the new list.
- ☐ Where the software will run (web, desktop, or phone), since that decides how dictation can be built.

- ☐ What "more than free text" means for Notes, for example a note type, a date and author stamp, or a link to a case, contact, or tickler.
- ☐ How the social security number is protected: masked on screen, limited to certain users, and encrypted in storage.
- ☐ Whether "Attorney" covers both co-counsel and opposing counsel, or opposing counsel needs its own type.
- ☐ Whether one contact can have more than one type, such as a client who is also a witness.
- ☐ Whether the case list order means most recently opened at the top, as the notes assume.
- ☐ Where running, dated notes go now that Notes is renamed Synopsis, and whether the ticklers sit under the Synopsis.
- ☐ Whether the Synopsis shows total medicals and total damages as two figures or one.
- ☐ Which insurance details the Synopsis shows, such as company, claim number, adjuster, and policy limits.
- ☐ Whether the Synopsis shows the social security number in full or masked, and who can see it.